counterparts. SMS is used for a number of interactive features in television programmes and radio shows, with the viewer messaging his response. The *Indian Idol* show reportedly received over 18 million text messages during its entire run.

A few widely-publicised speed contests have been held between expert Morse code operators and expert SMS users. Morse code has consistently won the contests, leading to speculation that cell phone manufacturers may eventually build a Morse code interface into cell phones. The interface would automatically translate the Morse code input into text so that it could be sent to any SMS-capable cell phone. This way, the receiver of the message need not know Morse code to read it. Other speculated applications include taking an existing application of Morse code and using the vibrating alert feature on the cell phone to translate short messages to Morse code for silent, hands free "reading" of the incoming messages.

Several cell phones already have informative audible Morse code ring tones and alert messages. For example, many Nokia cell phones have an option to beep SMS in Morse code when it receives a short message. There are third-party applications already available for some cell phones that allow Morse input for short messages.

Because of the limited message lengths and tiny user interface of mobile phones, SMS users commonly make extensive use of abbreviations, particularly the use of numbers for words (for instance, "4" in place of the word "for"), the omission of vowels, as in the phrase "txt msg", or the replacement of spaces with capitalisation. Historically, this language developed out of shorthand used in chat rooms on the Internet, where users would abbreviate words to allow a response to be typed more quickly. However, this became much more pronounced in SMS, where mobile phone users don't generally have access to a QWERTY keyboard as chat room users did, and more effort is required to type each character.